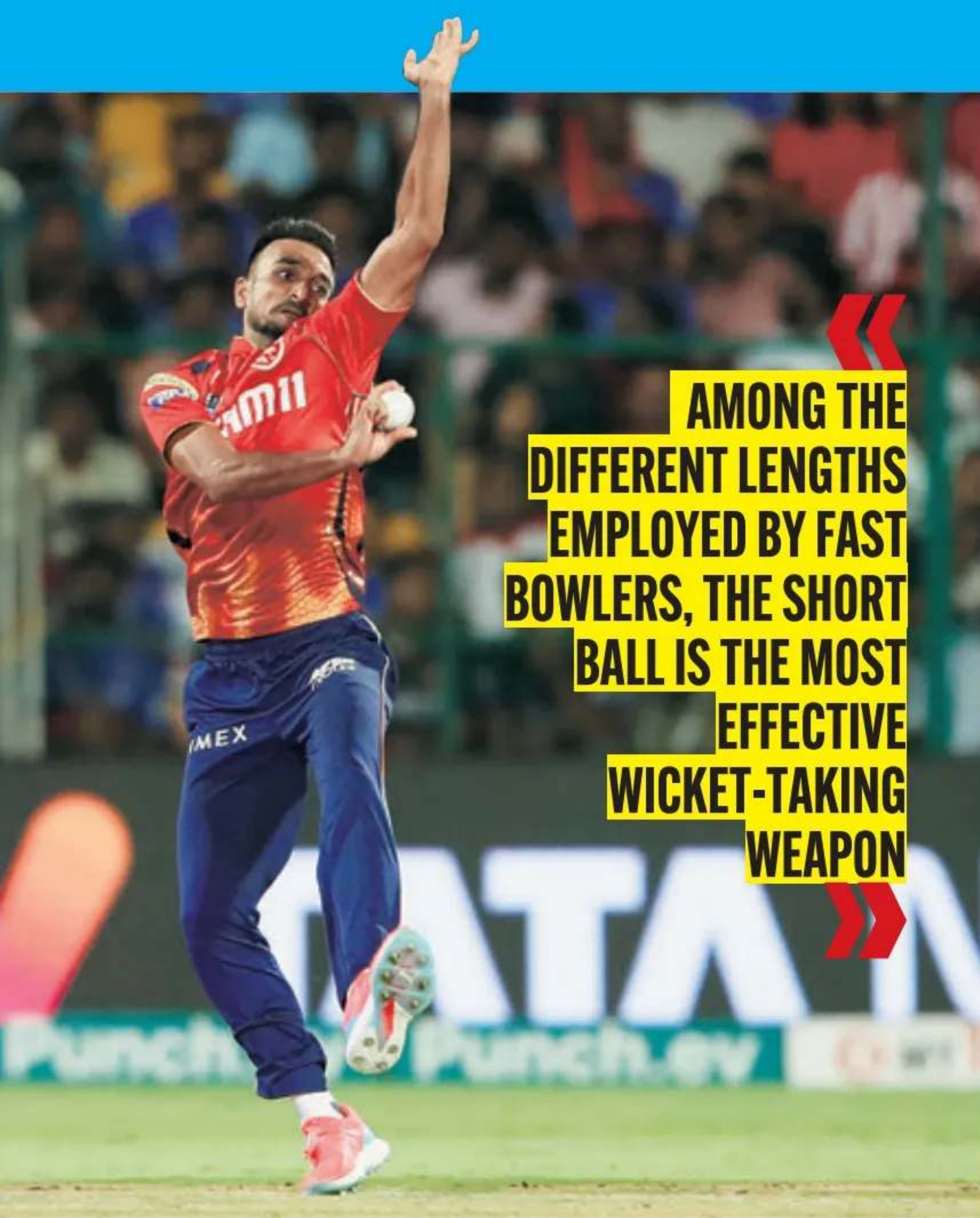




AMONG THE
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EMPLOYED BY FAST
BOWLERS, THE SHORT
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WICKET-TAKING
WEAPON

Not the be all and end all: Data suggests bouncers are a double-edged sword and their efficacy will more often than not depend on the craft and deceit of the bowler.

SPORTZPICS / IPL

instance of the new provision being used, and it emerged as a bowler's ally when the opposition was under the pump.

Short balls are more effective at the death (overs 17–20) this season. While they went at 11.23 runs per over in IPL 2023, in the current edition there is a considerable dip — 9.02 runs per over — a clear indication of the positive effect of the two-bouncer-per-over rule.

Data suggests bouncers are a double-edged sword, and their efficacy will more often than not depend on the craft and deceit of the bowler.

West Indies fast bowling legend Curtley Ambrose had decried the limit on bouncers permitted per over in an interview with *Sportstar* last year by saying, "Eighty percent of it [cricket] favours the batsman."

The latest ruling in the IPL may have taken the edge off that number a notch and made T20 bowling more than just an unforgiving walk of life.

Short Ball Run Rate

